

Note 1.6 Inverse Functions and Inverse Trigonometric Functions

One-to-One Functions

- **Definition:**

A function $f(x)$ is one-to-one on a domain D if and only if $f(x_1) \neq f(x_2)$ whenever $x_1 \neq x_2$ in D .

- **The Horizontal Line Test for One-to-One Functions**

A function $y = f(x)$ is one-to-one if and only if its graph intersects each horizontal line at most once.

Note:

increasing/decreasing $\implies$ one-to-one

one-to-one $\not\Rightarrow$ increasing/decreasing

Inverse Functions

- **Definition:**

If the function f is one-to-one on a domain D with range R , then the inverse function f^{-1} is defined by

$$f^{-1}(b) = a \text{ if } f(a) = b$$

The domain of f^{-1} is R and the range of f^{-1} is D .

- **Remarks:**

- f is increasing/decreasing $\implies f^{-1}$ increasing/decreasing
- f and f^{-1} is symmetric about $y = x$.

Inverse Trigonometric Functions

- Restrict their domains to intervals on which they are one-to-one.
- [Domain restrictions that make the trigonometric functions one-to-one](#)

The Arcsine and Arccosine Functions

- **Definition:**

$y = \sin^{-1} x$ is the number in $[-\frac{\pi}{2}, \frac{\pi}{2}]$ for which $\sin y = x$

$y = \cos^{-1} x$ is the number in $[0, \pi]$ for which $\cos y = x$

- **Identity:**

- $\sin^{-1}(-x) = -\sin^{-1} x$
- $\cos^{-1} x = \pi - \cos^{-1}(-x)$

- $\sin^{-1} x + \cos^{-1} x = \frac{\pi}{2}$

Elementary Functions

- Constant functions, power functions, exponential functions, logarithmic functions, trigonometric functions, inverse trigonometric functions and the functions combining them. (addition, subtraction, multiplication, quotient, composition)